

Stop speculators from taking Altadena

A fair recovery — not a fire sale.

As of June 12, 2026 · verify bill status before circulating

What's happening

After the Eaton Fire, outside investors are buying burned lots from survivors — often **elderly, underinsured families** — for far less than they're worth, then using a state law, **SB 1123**, to pack **up to 10 units** onto a single family's lot with **no public hearing**. **Many sellers may not be getting fair value for their land**. A pending bill (SB 1116) would make this harder to stop; another (SB 1090) is meant to protect us — but as written it starts too late and lets too many projects through.

The threat in numbers

45 of 94

recent lot sales bought by corporations
— up from just 5 a year earlier

up to 10

units a speculator can build on one
family's burned lot under SB 1123

no

public hearing required — almost no
say for the community or its neighbors

Altadena has long been a diverse, family-rooted community. Unchecked speculation strips generational wealth and displaces people who've lived here for decades. This isn't about blocking housing — it's about protecting survivors.

The three things we're asking for

1 Demand emergency action — Supervisor Barger must press the Governor for an executive order

Unlike the Palisades — which is largely exempt from these laws — Altadena has no such protection, and speculation has followed. As our representative and SB 1090's sponsor, Supervisor Barger has the standing and the power to get the Governor to act. She must **press the Governor for an executive order protecting Altadena now**. SB 1090 doesn't take effect until 2027, and survivors can't wait.

2 Fix the dates and close the loophole — SB 1090 & SB 1116

Make the protection apply **from the fire date, January 7, 2025, through January 7, 2030, to every project without an issued building permit as of the earliest possible date** — so speculators can't race to file before it takes effect.

3 A community master plan — and accountability for the windfall

Require a **community-led master plan** during the pause, and make the **County** — which profits from higher property taxes — accountable so that when land values rise, the gain goes to **survivors, not speculators**.

What you can do — today

Call and email your representatives. Phone calls count most. Use these points:

- I'm an Altadena community member. **Predatory speculators are taking burned lots from fire survivors** for a fraction of their value.
- **Supervisor Barger / Governor:** issue an emergency order suspending SB 9 & SB 1123 in Altadena now — the Palisades already got it.
- **Senator Pérez / Assemblymember Harabedian:** amend SB 1090 to run from Jan 7, 2025 through 2030 and cover any project without a building permit; exempt Altadena from SB 1116.
- Require a **community master plan**, and don't let the land-value windfall go to speculators instead of survivors.

Subject: Protect Altadena fire survivors — fix SB 1090 and act now

Dear [Senator Pérez / Assemblymember Harabedian / Supervisor Barger / Governor Newsom],

I'm a member of the Altadena community. Outside investors are buying burned lots from traumatized, often elderly and underinsured fire survivors — many of them longtime, multigenerational residents — for a fraction of their true value, then using SB 1123 to subdivide them into up to 10 units. This is stripping generational wealth from a community that has already lost everything.

I urge you to: (1) **issue or request an emergency executive order now** suspending SB 9 and SB 1123 in the Eaton Fire area (ZIP 91001/91003) — the same protection the Palisades received; (2) **amend SB 1090**, and exempt Altadena from SB 1116, so the moratorium runs from **January 7, 2025 through January 7, 2030** and applies to any project **without an issued building permit as of the earliest possible date**; and (3) require a **community-led master plan** during the moratorium and a mechanism so rising land values benefit survivors, not speculators.

Altadena deserves a fair recovery. Please stand with our survivors.

[Your name · street address · ZIP code]

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